THE NEXT 100

ENTERTAINERS

TAKING HIS CHANCES

KARTIK AARYAN, 30

Actor



Photograph by **BANDEEP SINGH**

Since his debut at 20 with the sleeper hit *Pyaar Ka Punchnama* (2011), Kartik Aaryan has gradually edged his way into becoming one of the leading young men of Hindi cinema. It's all the more impressive given that the Gwalior-born actor didn't have any connections in the Hindi film industry when he first landed in Mumbai as an 18-year-old. "There's no second chance for me. It's always been the only chance, film or character to prove myself," he says. He capitalised on the few chances to effectively portray the angst of young Indian men in a string of friends-centred comedies—the two *Pyaar Ka Punchnama* films and *Sonu Ke Titu Ki Sweety*—and later expanded his fan base among the youth with *Luka Chuppi* and *Pati, Patni aur Woh* which touch on live-in relationships and adultery respectively. There's been a conscious effort to try different genres and seek interesting directors to collaborate with. "Lots of people say, '*Chalti gaadi ke engine ko mat chhedo* (Don't mess with the engine of a car that's running well)", he says. "But I have never thought of losses. I have always seen the silver lining." ■

–Suhani Singh

FRAME AND FORTUNE **Kartik's first pay-check—Rs 1,500 for a commercial that he did—lies unspent as his parents have framed it**